this coercion took place in the Calcutta Corporation. Ultimately, I believe, the Bengal Government passed a law against the employment by the Corporation of persons who had been convicted for political offences.

Reports of Nazi excesses in Germany had a curious effect on British officials and their Press in India. They gave them a justification for all they had done in India, and it was pointed out to us, with a glow of conscious virtue, how much worse our lot would have been if the Nazis had had anything to do with us. New standards and records had been set up by the Nazis, and it was certainly not an easy matter to rival them. Perhaps our lot would have been worse; it is difficult for me to judge for I have not all the facts of the occurrences that have taken place in various parts of India during the past five years. The British Government in India believes in the charity that its right hand should not know what its left hand does, and so it has turned down every suggestion for an impartial enquiry, although such enquiries are always weighted on the official side. I think it is true that the average Englishman hates brutality, and I cannot conceive English people openly glorying in and repeating lovingly the word '*Brutalität*' (or its English equivalent) as the Nazis do. Even when they indulge in the deed, they are a little ashamed of it. But whether we are Germans or English or Indians, I am afraid our veneer of civilised conduct is thin enough, and when passions are aroused it rubs off and reveals something that is not good to look at. The Great War brutalised humanity terribly, and we saw the aftermath of this in that awful hunger blockade of Germany even after the Armistice—"one of the most senseless, brutal and hideous atrocities ever committed by any nation" as an English writer has described it. The years 1857 and 1858 have not been forgotten in India. Whenever the challenge to our own interests is made we forget our good breeding and society manners, and untruth becomes 'propaganda', and brutality 'scientific repression' and the preservation of 'law and order'.

It is not the fault of individuals or any particular people. More or less every one behaves so under similar circumstances. In India, and in every country under foreign domination, there is always a latent challenge to the ruling power, and from time to time this becomes more obvious and threatening. This challenge always develops the military virtues and vices in the ruling groups. We have had evidence of these military virtues and vices in a superlative degree in India during the last few